

What resources can we take advantage of in preparation for our applications?

- **Google** (all day, every day). Google has everything that you need. You can find your school websites from Google in a jiff. Always go for the first search results - don't scroll down and click on the last searches. The algorithm is designed to offer the MOST RELEVANT INFO as the FIRST SEARCH RESULTS. Make sure to always consult the official school website first when you're researching your schools.
- **Reddit**. I don't want to discredit the information that is offered on the school websites, but you also need to know that these schools need to maintain a certain image for the public. They will never talk about their shortcomings openly. This is where things like Reddit become useful. Reddit users are people like you and me, who aren't going to lose anything if they tell the truth. But be careful with what you read, remaining objective about the schools because these are people's opinions you are reading, not proven facts.

How to use Reddit?

Let's say we want to know the best universities in engineering according to Reddit.

You'll go Google and search "the best universities in engineering Reddit answers" and choose the most relevant first search results. There is usually an upvote/downvote feature on Reddit, which is basically a UP arrow and a DOWN arrow on the bottom left side of a Reddit comment. I'd advise you to trust the most upvoted comments that have credible sources tagged on them.

- **Quora**. It works exactly like Reddit.

I think it's important to keep in mind that **the most trusted source is the school website**. Using Quora and Reddit is to supplement the info you've learned from the school websites. If you notice similarities across all these platforms, then you'd know that the information is true in Quora and Reddit.

What are the pre med track courses?

- *Hussein Fuaad*, class of 2023 at Johns Hopkins University is doing pre med. He is currently majoring in Computer Science. He said you can major in anything as long as you take the premed-specific classes in your undergrad. Some of the classes are calculus, all introductory sciences, organic chemistry, a few public health/ neuroscience classes.

What does "personalizing the recommendation letters" mean?

- This means that the recommender needs to describe you like someone who knows you at a personal level. It means that they will not just mention your traits as shallow

descriptions, e.g. *Edith is a humorous student. She always made us laugh, especially during mentally strenuous classes.*

Instead, they would use vivid descriptions, e.g. *From her way with words to her avocado shirt that reads 'Avo Nice Day', Edith was a lover of light-hearted moments as well. From our conversations and class discussions, she knew when to stretch a good argument humorously while also holding tact.*

This is what I mean when I say you need to show and not tell. Illustrate how you showed a particular trait, as I did in the last example. Do not just simply mention the trait, like mentioning that you are determined, resilient, etc. SHOW, DON'T TELL.

Also note that this information applies to the essays as well, from your personal statement to the supplemental essays. Try your best to show, not tell, as hard as it might be sometimes.